

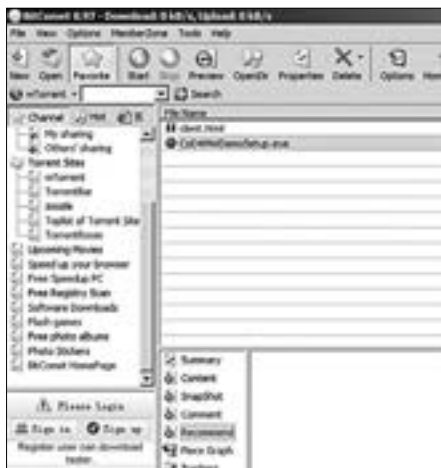
prior to downloading the client is enough to put you off. The file download is deliberately throttled by the site, leading to extremely slow downloads—3 to 4 KBps! And this is done to prove the point that downloads would be faster with BitComet installed.

In a world of abundant options, it would not be wise to expect you to silently endure this irrational behaviour—even if it is a matter of 5 MB. Besides these issues, BC is also buggy and prone to whimsical activities that are beyond your control.

BC is more than just a BT client. It bundles some tools: a Flash Video player (for .flv files beamed on sites like YouTube) that can only be accessed from the Program Files menu; the BitComet Resource Browser, which is a modified version of Internet Explorer; and a download manager. Besides these, two standalone applications can be downloaded from within BC, and though they are called plugins, they do not depend on BC for their functionality. The “plugins” are eMule, an eD2K client (discussed in a later section), and a media player (MPC star).

4.3.2 Usage

At every launch, unless you have tweaked your system with network utilities to maximise speeds, a pop-up will recommend increasing the number of “Half-open TCP Connections.” A TCP connection is half-open when it is awaiting confirmation from the target PC about availability of a port than can be used for data transfer. Increasing the number of allowed half-open connections allows more peers to be simultaneously contacted, which in turn increases the speed with which



The main BitComet interface